

Mapping the Geographies of Gambling

Great Britain Gambling Behaviours Classification



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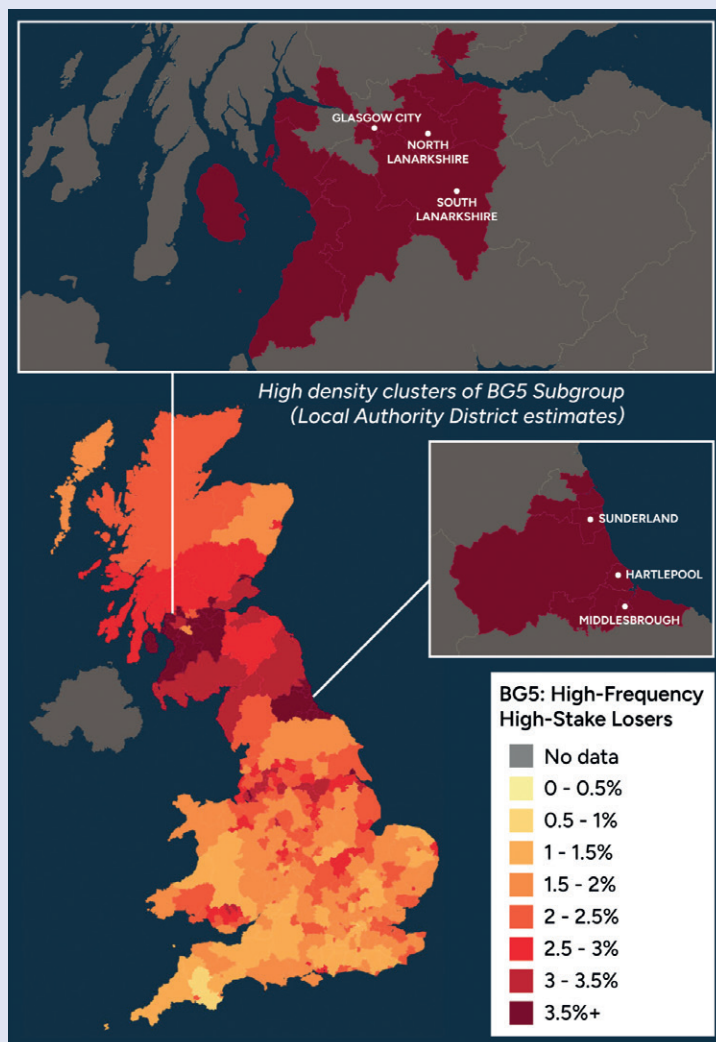
Smart Data Approach to Studying Gambling Activities

The Great Britain Gambling Behaviours Classification (GB2C) provides the first national areal classification of gambling behaviours in Great Britain (GB), based on observed online transactional behaviours drawn from industry data. The GB2C draws on over one million anonymised online gambling accounts, with their activities recorded over a 12-month period, provided by one of the 'Big Five' British gambling operators. Using this unique data source, customers were segmented into 11 Active Subgroups, with additional estimates for non-Active account holders. This data product pushes the frontiers of social science methodology, empowering researchers to develop deeper insights into the complexities of gambling behaviour in GB, at spatial scales previously impossible to achieve.

Behavioural and Spatial Patterns of Online Gambling

The GB2C dataset applies a small-area estimation approach to model the geographic distribution of online gambling behaviours across GB. Regional-level customer counts were used to create Local Authority District (LAD) and Lower layer Super Output Area (LSOA) level estimates using decile-ranked estimates of gambling penetration profiles and local population Census data. Market share adjustments benchmarked to national prevalence rates derived from the Gambling Survey for Great Britain (GSGB) are used to ensure consistency of estimates with known patterns of gambling participation online. The resulting estimates provide neighbourhood-level counts of adults segmented by 13 classifications of online gambling behaviours. The data are provided in CSV format, with a detailed glossary of terms, descriptive statistics and pen portraits.

Empowering Spatially Targeted Interventions to Address Harms



The growth of online gambling in GB remains largely obscured, rendering its true scale and impact challenging to ascertain. Understanding both how and where gambling-related behaviours manifest is essential for informing targeted interventions and evidence-based public policy.

For example, the BG5: High-Frequency High-Stake Losers Subgroup is nested within the Betting-and-Gaming (BG) Group.

Participants invest substantially in both time and money, gambling online on more than half the days of the year at regular intervals. Their average monthly deposit and loss amounts are approximately six times the Active Gambler Supergroup average. Despite these adverse outcomes, they represent the most established cohort within the BG Group, with typical registration periods exceeding three years.

LAD data are openly available to download from data.geods.ac.uk and visible through our interactive web mapping tool mapmaker.geods.ac.uk. LSOA data are made available for approved research purposes upon successful application from data.geods.ac.uk.

